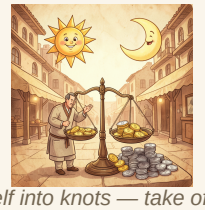
LAF YOMI

Bekhorot 50 · November 07, 2026

ON TODAY'S DAF

Bekhorot 50 is all about money — the Tyrian maneh: five selaim of פדיון הבן, thirty of the slave, fifty of the seducer, a hundred of the מוציא שם רע, all in שקל הקודש. The Amoraim argue over post-Temple currency, Rava's 3■-dinar sela, the money-changer's fee, Rav Ashi's seventeen zuz, and the rule that all כסף in the Torah is כסף צורי — closing with חנן בישא's double ear-strike.

דינרא הדריאנא טרייאנא · THE SUN, THE MOON, AND THE 12:1 EXCHANGE RATE



1. Tosafot asks: why does the Gemara twist itself into knots — take off a sixth, then a zuz, then a zuz and then a sixth — just to get from 25 silver coins down to 20? Why not simply take off a fifth?

“A gold dinar is twice as thick as a silver one, and gold is worth twelve times silver — so one gold dinar buys 25 silvers. And why twelve? Gold comes from the sun, silver from the moon — and the moon laps the sun twelve times a year.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 50a · דינרא הדריאנא טרייאנא — gold from the sun, silver from the moon · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 19:43

בתר דאוסיפו עלייהו · THE SHEKEL THAT CAN ONLY GO UP



2. The baraita proves you may add to the shekel — עשרים גרה השקל... יהיה' — the shekel grew from 3■ dinars to 4. But may it ever go down again?

“תלמוד לומר הוא 'יכול יפחות? — it can only go up, never down. The Torah's shekel: Chazal may raise it, but nobody may ever cut it.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 50a · בתר דאוסיפו עלייהו — the shekel that can only go up · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 27:54

שיבסר זוזי · THE PIDYON-HABEN HAGGLE OVER CHANGE



3. Rav Ashi sends 17 zuz to Rav Aha the kohen for a pidyon haben, with a note: send me back a third of a zuz in change — five selaim at 3■ each is only 16■.

“Rav Aha writes back: 'Send me three more.' The shekel went up to 4 dinars, so five selaim is 20 — Rav Ashi underpaid by three. The father wants change, the kohen wants a top-up.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 50a · רב אשי שדר שיבסר זוזי — seventeen zuz and a fight over the change · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 28:42

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ביקשו לגנוז · CHAZAL VS. THE WORLD'S MONEY SUPPLY



4. Rabbi Oshaya: Chazal wanted to hide away — to ban — all the silver and gold in the entire world, because it might be Jerusalem's hekdesh money.

“The Gemara objects: is Jerusalem the majority of the world? Abaye narrows it: only the worn Hadrian and Trajan dinars — the Temple-era coins. From banning the world's money supply to banning two old coins: a very Gemara-style climbdown.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 50a · ביקשו לגנוז כל כסף וזהב — hide all the world's silver and gold · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 34:42

ובאו בה פריצים וחיללוה · THE KOTEL SOUVENIR QUESTION



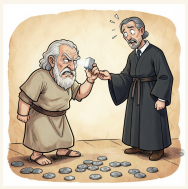
5. People asked Rav Moshe Feinstein: may we chip off Kotel stones as souvenirs? The Gemara's rule — 'ובאו בה פריצים וחיללוה,' the invaders profaned the Temple, so its hekdesh money lost its sanctity — would seem to allow it.

“Rav Moshe: no. That verse covers only what was destroyed — and the Shechinah never left the Western Wall, so its sanctity remains. The Kotel is not a souvenir shop; the one stone you may not take home is the one still standing.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 50a · ובאו בה פריצים וחיללוה — can you take a Kotel stone home? · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 39:46

חנן בישא · THE FINE PAID WITH A SECOND OFFENCE



6. Chanan Bisha boxed a man's ear. Rav Huna fined him half a zuz — the rabbinic sela for boshes. Problem: Chanan only had a whole zuz, and it was so rubbed-out nobody would accept it as currency.

“The victim refused the deal — he'd hand back a good half-zuz in change for a worthless whole one. So Chanan hit him again: now he owed two half-zuzim, a whole zuz exactly. The Ben Yehoyada: his name says it all — he paid his fine and committed a second offence to avoid making change.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 50b · חנן בישא תקע ליה — hit him twice so the change works out · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 49:27